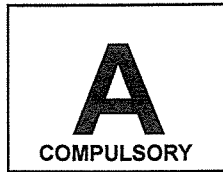


Candidate Number											
------------------	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

**HKDSE 2025
ENGLISH LANGUAGE
PAPER 1 PART A
QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK**



Please stick the barcode label here.

Write your Candidate Number and stick a barcode label in the space provided on this page.

Read Text 1 and answer questions 1-21. (42 marks)

Text 1

1. According to paragraph 1, Joe Jonas...

- A. intends to divorce his wife.
- B. dislikes celebrity breakups.
- C. has many high-profile friends.
- D. loves following celebrity gossip.

A	B	C	D
☐	☐	☐	☐

2. According to paragraph 1, why is 2023 called 'The Year of Celebrity Breakups' (lines 3-4)?

3. Find TWO phrases used in paragraph 1 to refer to 'Breakups' (line 4).

(2 marks)

(i) _____

(ii) _____

4. Who or what is the writer referring to when they use the phrase "down here in the 'real' world" (line 7)?

5. What does 'it' refer to?

(2 marks)

(i) 'it' (line 8) _____

(ii) 'it' (line 14) _____

6. Why would it 'come as a shock' (line 16) when the public realise a celebrity's family life is not as happy as they thought?

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.



7. The flow chart shows the sequence of events described in paragraph 3. Fill in each blank with ONE word taken from paragraph 3. (5 marks)

The glamorous, rich and successful lifestyles of celebrities represent people's (i) _____.



People believe such celebrities are untouched by ordinary people's (ii) _____.



The (iii) _____ discover 'what's happening behind the scenes' with celebrities.



Seeing that celebrities have similar experiences as ordinary people (iv) _____ celebrities.



People are puzzled: if someone is successful he / she shouldn't (v) _____ such problems.

8. According to paragraph 4, decide whether the following statements are True (T), False (F) or Not Given (NG). (4 marks)

Statements

- (i) The APA states all gossip is not supported by evidence.
 (ii) Some gossip may be harmful or upset people.
 (iii) Gossip is different in different cultures.
 (iv) Gossip doesn't play a role in developing relationships with others.

T	F	NG
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐

9. The writer uses the phrase 'Put simply' (line 23)...

- A. to give an example.
 B. to clarify a complex point.
 C. to present a contrasting idea.
 D. to challenge a reader's ideas about the topic.

A	B	C	D
☐	☐	☐	☐

10. Why does gossip help people become 'more prepared for what's coming' (line 30)?

11. What words does the writer use in paragraph 8 to highlight contrasting ideas?

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

12. Find the metaphor the writer uses in paragraph 9 to describe 'an attack on someone's social status.'

13. According to paragraph 9, what is claimed to be the main reason for gossiping?

- A. Making friends
- B. Putting down others
- C. Learning about other people
- D. Wanting to look better than others

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

14. Find a word in paragraphs 9-10 which has a similar meaning to each word given below.

(5 marks)

- (i) 'reason' _____
- (ii) 'behave' _____
- (iii) 'enhance' _____
- (iv) 'outcome' _____
- (v) 'described' _____

15. Who or what does 'A-listers' (line 50) refer to?

16. According to paragraph 12, what are 'parasocial relationships' (line 52)?

- A. Following the successes of celebrities
- B. Making friends with a singer or athlete
- C. Having a connection only in our mind with people we admire
- D. Attempting to meet a celebrity in order to make friends with them

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

17. With reference to paragraph 12, explain how 'parasocial relationships' (line 52) can be beneficial.

18. Find one example of 'difficult feelings' (line 63) Benning is referring to in paragraph 13.

19. Which of the following best describes the intention of the writer of Text 1?

- A. To present new research
- B. To explain how to do something
- C. To help understand people's motives
- D. To criticise a new social phenomenon

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

20. Based on the information in Text 1, decide whether each of the four people agrees, disagrees or neither agrees nor disagrees with the statement ‘Celebrity gossip may benefit us.’ by blackening the appropriate circle.

(4 marks)

Opinion towards the statement: ‘Celebrity gossip may benefit us.’

	Agrees	Disagrees	Neither agrees nor disagrees
(i) Dr. Alice Leppert	☐	☐	☐
(ii) Dr. Andrea Liner	☐	☐	☐
(iii) Dr. David Ludden	☐	☐	☐
(iv) Dr. Stephen Benning	☐	☐	☐

21. Two friends are discussing Text 1. Use the information from paragraphs 6-14 to match each statement in the conversation below with a paragraph that contains similar ideas. Write the number of the paragraph (6-14) in the speech bubble. Use each paragraph number ONCE only. Some paragraph numbers are NOT used. The first has been done for you as an example.

(6 marks)

1. “My brother was telling me about his new job. He’s made friends with his new colleagues whilst chatting about Taylor Swift.”

Paragraph 13 (example)

2. “That reminds me of an article I’ve been reading about gossiping. You know, just sharing the latest news about people who are not in the room.”

(i) Paragraph _____

3. “Gossiping? Isn’t that bad mouthing people? That’s not a good thing to do. It’s not good for you or others.”

(ii) Paragraph _____

Peter



5. “I guess so. Sometimes hearing about celebrities messing up does make me feel my life isn’t that bad after all.”

(iv) Paragraph _____

4. “Well it can be but this article said that bad mouthing actually can have a positive outcome.”

(iii) Paragraph _____

Mary



7. “I suppose for some it makes them feel like having connection with someone when they feel alone.”

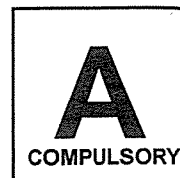
(vi) Paragraph _____

6. “The article made me question why we do gossip about people like Taylor Swift.”

(v) Paragraph _____

END OF PART A

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.



ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 1

PART A

Reading Passages

8:30 am – 10:00 am (1 hour 30 minutes)
(for both Parts A and B)

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

- (1) There are two parts (A and B) in this paper. All candidates should attempt Part A. In Part B, you should attempt either Part B1 (easier section) OR Part B2 (more difficult section). Candidates attempting Parts A and B2 will be able to attain the full range of levels, while Level 4 will be the highest level attainable for candidates attempting Parts A and B1.
- (2) After the announcement of the start of the examination, you should first write your Candidate Number and stick barcode labels in the spaces provided on the appropriate pages of the Part A Question-Answer Book and the Part B Question-Answer Book which you are going to attempt.
- (3) Write your answers in the spaces provided in the Question-Answer Books. Answers written in the margins will not be marked.
- (4) For multiple-choice questions, you are advised to blacken the appropriate circle with a pencil so that wrong marks can be completely erased with a clean rubber. Mark only **ONE** answer to each question. Two or more answers will score **NO MARKS**.
- (5) Supplementary answer sheets will be supplied on request. Use separate supplementary answer sheets for Part A and Part B. Write your Candidate Number, mark the question number box and stick a barcode label on each sheet, and fasten them with string **INSIDE** the relevant Question-Answer Book.
- (6) No extra time will be given to candidates for sticking on barcode labels or filling in the question number boxes after the 'Time is up' announcement.
- (7) The two Question-Answer Books you have attempted (one for Part A and one for Part B) will be collected together at the end of the examination. Fasten the two Question-Answer Books together with the green tag provided.
- (8) The unused Question-Answer Book for Part B will be collected separately at the end of the examination. This will not be marked. Do not write any answers in it.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PART A

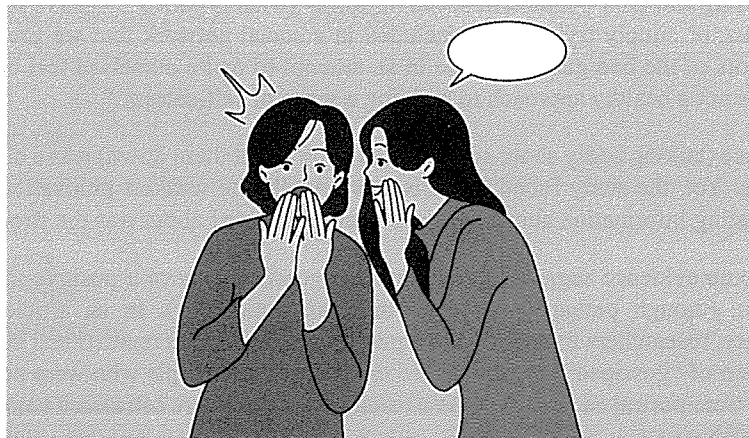
- (1) The Question-Answer Book for Part A is inserted in this Reading Passages booklet.
- (2) Attempt ALL questions in Part A. Each question carries ONE mark unless otherwise stated.

Not to be taken away before the
end of the examination session

PART A

Read Text 1 and answer questions 1-21 in the Question-Answer Book for Part A.

Text 1 Celebrity Gossip



- 1 [1] It's 2023 and Joe Jonas has filed for divorce from Sophie Turner after four years of marriage. Other personalities, including Taylor Swift and Joe Alwyn, Ariana Grande and Dalton Gomez, as well as Hugh Jackman and Deborra Lee all split up. In fact, so many high-profile pairs have called it quits that some people have deemed 2023 'The Year of Celebrity Breakups.'
- 5 [2] Logically speaking, we shouldn't be interested in this kind of scandalous speculation, this celebrity gossip. The inner lives of celebrities have next to nothing to do with us, after all: we're unlikely ever to meet them, and their romantic relationships have no bearing on how our own lives unravel, down here in the 'real' world. "And yet we are interested, even if we're reluctant to admit it," says Dr. Alice Leppert, a media and communications professor who focuses on stardom and celebrity culture.
- 10 [3] These public figures represent a lot of our highest goals, declares clinical psychologist and breakup coach Dr. Andrea Liner. They tend to be attractive, wealthy, and considered successful, which many people assume makes them invulnerable to a lot of life's problems. "So, when we find out that beautiful, gorgeous, wealthy celebrities are getting cheated on or divorcing or breaking up, it kind of humanizes them and can be validating for us to see that they have problems, too," she says. "But it can also confuse us because we think that they shouldn't be having problems like
- 15 that if they've achieved these levels of success. Part of the problem is that celebrities may often perform an image or identity that doesn't always align with their authentic selves," she adds. Their marital problems can come as a shock if all the public saw was a happy family. Liner says that's especially true because celebrities share so much of their lives online, creating an "almost artificial sense of intimacy" that obscures what's happening behind the scenes.
- 20 [4] Gossip is so central to our cultural psyche that the American Psychological Association (APA) has its own definition. According to the APA, gossip consists of personal talk or communication about information that's often not proven to be true, and it may be (but is not necessarily) scandalous in content or malicious in intention. Gossip impacts group bonding and has big implications for the transmission and reinforcement of cultural norms, too.
- [5] But why? What purpose does gossip serve? What function is it fulfilling in our society? Put simply, why do we care?
- 25 [6] "There are some people who try to classify gossip as negative or critical discussion about other people, but really, gossip is just sharing social information with each other," says author and professor of psychology Dr. David Ludden. "Anytime you're talking about people who aren't present, it's gossip," he says. "We're social animals and we need to be able to know what's going on in social environments, so gossip is very helpful," says Ludden, who studies the psychology of language and how it shapes and is shaped by our social world. Basically, gossip can help you go into
- 30 social encounters more prepared for what's coming. "I don't have to have an encounter with someone directly to have some idea what they're like, because other people are telling me about their encounters with them," says Ludden.

35 [7] It can also be a way to build relationships: “Sharing gossip can bond people socially,” says Dr. Stephen Benning from the University of Nevada, Las Vegas. Benning published a study in 2019 which found that gossip provides a currency of private information that creates a shared sense of the community holding that information. So, gossip is particularly compelling for people who are seeking to connect with others.

40 [8] But it’s not all so innocent. Benning found that we’re also attracted to gossip for some other reasons: attacking people’s social standing and their position in social networks (what is called ‘negative influence’), merely elevating our own social status, or simply trying to be included in a social network that we previously weren’t. Similarly, Ludden says that “lots of the bad gossip is done in an attempt to make ourselves feel better than the person we’re talking about. That’s not a healthy approach to building a sense of self-esteem.”

[9] Negative influence (talking badly about someone or trying to cut them down) was a clear motive for some people on certain occasions. Yet, the study found that this was actually the weakest motivation that led people to gossip. Gathering and validating information about the person being gossiped about was the strongest.

45 [10] There’s also some evidence suggesting that negative gossip can have a positive impact on social groups and promote cooperation (though perhaps not in the most altruistic way). In an article published in the journal Psychological Science, researchers found that when people communicated reputational information about others (the researchers’ definition of “gossiped”), others tended to interact with people who were portrayed as cooperative and ostracize those who were portrayed as selfish. As a result, those who were ostracized tended to change their behavior and act more cooperatively.

50 [11] What motivates us to gossip about A-listers we don’t socialize with?

[12] Ludden says that just because we’ve never met these celebrities doesn’t mean we don’t have relationships with them: “What we do is we create parasocial relationships — imaginary relationships with a singer or athlete whose successes we’ve followed and celebrated.” Like gossip itself, these parasocial relationships can be healthy or unhealthy depending on the circumstances. They can fill the gaps in our real-world relationships, and they’re a risk-free way to feel connected to others, since you can’t be rejected by someone who’s not actually in a relationship with you.

60 [13] Gossiping about these celebrities can be a similarly low-stakes way to feel connected, since the information you’re sharing doesn’t pose a risk to you or a member of your social circle. “It can feel uncomfortable and vulnerable to share information about your own worlds,” Benning says. “Gossiping about celebrities is a safer way to interact with a date, to ingratiate yourself to a group at parties, or to feel part of a new team at work.” It can also serve as a form of stress relief. “When life is overwhelming, focusing on celebrity gossip can be a way to numb out our feelings of dissatisfaction, unhappiness, or stress,” says Benning. “Scrolling through celebrity gossip puts us in a dissociated state where we can take breaks from difficult feelings.”

65 [14] But just like regular gossip, sometimes the motivation behind celebrity gossip is to make ourselves feel better than others. “Celebrity gossip is a safe way to snack on schadenfreude (the delight in the misfortune of others),” says Benning. “It feels a lot less shameful to admit we enjoy watching celebrity misfortunes than to admit we enjoy watching the misfortunes of family and friends.”

END OF READING PASSAGE

Sources of materials used in this paper will be acknowledged in the *HKDSE Question Papers* booklet published by the Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority at a later stage.

**HKDSE 2025
ENGLISH LANGUAGE
PAPER 1 PART B1
QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK**

B1
EASY SECTION

Write your Candidate Number and stick a barcode label in the space provided on this page.

Read Texts 2 to 4 and answer questions 22-42. (42 marks)

Text 2

22. Who is Text 2 written for?

People who...

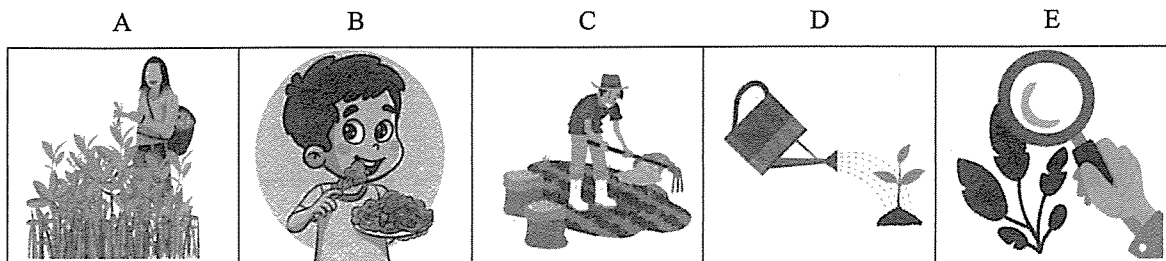
- A. dislike foraging.
B. are new to foraging.
C. want to stop foraging.
D. know a lot about foraging.

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

23. Select one of the menu options in the header above paragraph 1 to complete each gap in the table below. Use each option ONCE only. The first has been done for you as an example. Some menu options are NOT used. (3 marks)

If you want to...	choose the following menu option
...meet other foragers	Join Us (<i>example</i>)
...watch a lesson on foraging	(i)
...read more about this topic	(ii)
...learn how to cook your finds	(iii)

24. Identify TWO of the following that are NOT mentioned in paragraph 1 by circling the letters (A-E).

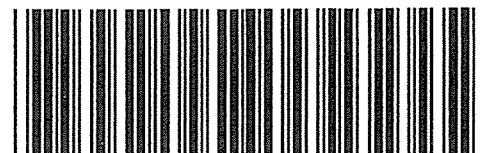


25. Which of the following best replaces 'every' (line 4)?

- A. one
B. your
C. each
D. many

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.



* A 0 2 0 E 1 B 1 *

26. Using the information in paragraph 4, complete the following sentence by using ONE word taken from the paragraph for each gap. (2 marks)

To understand the (i) _____ we all belong to, look (ii) _____ and learn all you can about the local plant life.

27. State ONE piece of advice from paragraphs 3-7 to protect the health of foragers.

28. The main purpose of Text 2 is to...

- A. debate.
B. inform.
C. criticise.
D. entertain.

A	B	C	D
☐	☐	☐	☐

Text 3

29. According to paragraphs 1-2, decide whether the following statements are True (T), False (F) or Not Given (NG). (4 marks)

Statements	T	F	NG
(i) Huang has been foraging for many years.	☐	☐	☐
(ii) Huang taught her dad about foraging herbs and plants.	☐	☐	☐
(iii) Huang used foraged ingredients to make breakfast.	☐	☐	☐
(iv) Huang started teaching foraging in Canada.	☐	☐	☐

30. Complete the following sentence using the information from paragraph 2.

Huang believes her childhood experience illustrates how foraging can _____ as it did for hunter-gatherers.

31. With reference to paragraph 3, complete the sentence below by using a word or phrase taken from the paragraph.

Compared with foraged plants, store-bought plants are _____.

32. Find a word in paragraph 4 which can be replaced by each word given below. (3 marks)

- (i) 'prestigious' _____
- (ii) 'sector' _____
- (iii) 'well-liked' _____

33. What does 'rich pickings' (line 18) refer to?

- A. A wide variety of plants to forage
- B. The strong flavour of foraged plants
- C. A lot of medicinal products made from foraged plants
- D. The money foragers can make selling to high-end restaurants

A B C D
○ ○ ○ ○

34. Find TWO examples in paragraph 5 of the 'high biodiversity' (line 18) in Hong Kong. (2 marks)

(i) _____

(ii) _____

35. Complete the following summary of paragraph 6 with a word or phrase taken from the paragraph. (4 marks)

Hong Kong Citizens: Most people today spend (i) _____ at their job so they have no time for (ii) _____.

Old Village Residents: Luckily this group have all the (iii) _____ needed to forage in their own neighbourhood.
--

Wanda Huang: Her passion is to restore people's (iv) _____ to the world around them.
--

36. Look at the information in paragraphs 1-6 and match each paragraph to the headings below. Use each paragraph number ONCE only. One heading does NOT refer to any of the paragraphs and you should put a cross (X). One has been done for you as an example. (6 marks)

Headings

- (i) Local businesses embrace the world of foraging
- (ii) Definition of foraging
- (iii) Respect for wisdom of the elderly
- (iv) Passing knowledge to the next generation
- (v) Why are they better?
- e.g. Meeting a local forager
- (vi) Our location means we are lucky

Paragraph Number

1 (example)

Text 4

37. Who or what does 'the species' (line 5) refer to? _____

38. With reference to paragraph 3, explain how Wright progressed from a challenge to a career.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

39. What is 'a privilege' (line 11) for Wright?

40. With reference to paragraph 5, what does Wright indicate is a less obvious attraction of foraging?

41. Find a word or phrase from paragraph 5 and paragraph 7 that can be replaced by 'from my perspective.'
(2 marks)

(i) Paragraph 5 _____

(ii) Paragraph 7 _____

Read Texts 2, 3 and 4 and answer question 42.

42. Below are comments made by the people and the organisation in Text 2, Text 3 and Text 4. Match each with ONE comment that best represents them. Use each letter ONCE only. One comment is NOT used. (4 marks)

Person / Organisation

Comment

AFCD (Text 2)

(i) _____

Wanda Huang (Text 3)

(ii) _____

Uwe Opocensky (Text 3)

(iii) _____

John Wright (Text 4)

(iv) _____

A. It's amazing, one mushroom has changed my entire life.

B. It's most important to first speak to someone who knows what they are doing.

C. If you try them yourself you'll agree with me. Totally delicious!

D. Know what you're doing before you embark on any foraging trip.

E. I can't stand by and let our heritage be lost.

END OF PART B1

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 1

PART B1

Reading Passages

8:30 am – 10:00 am (1 hour 30 minutes)
(for both Parts A and B)

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

- (1) Refer to the General Instructions on Page 1 of the Reading Passages booklet for Part A.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PART B1

- (1) The Question-Answer Book for Part B1 is inserted in this Reading Passages booklet.
- (2) Candidates who choose Part B1 should attempt all questions in this part. Each question carries ONE mark unless otherwise stated.
- (3) Hand in only ONE Question-Answer Book for Part B, either B1 or B2, and fasten it with the Question-Answer Book for Part A using the green tag provided.

Not to be taken away before the
end of the examination session

PART B1

Read Texts 2-4 and answer questions 22-42 in the Question-Answer Book for Part B1.

Text 2

<https://www.foraginginhongkongforbeginners.com.hk/home/>



Foraging in Hong Kong for Beginners

[Home](#)[Foraging Info](#)[Videos](#)[Recipes](#)[About Us](#)[Join Us](#)

What is Foraging?

[1] Foraging is identifying, collecting, and eating plants like herbs, fruits, and nuts that grow wild in nature.

Foraging Guidelines

[2] Here are some rules that every forager should follow:

- [3] Never start solo. It's essential to begin by partnering up with a local expert who can teach you the best ways to forage while also keeping you safe.
- [4] Familiarise yourself with the herbs, bushes, and trees around you. Try to learn as much as possible about the ecosystem of which you are a part.
- [5] Learn to identify the poisonous plants you are likely to encounter. **DO NOT EAT ANYTHING YOU CANNOT POSITIVELY IDENTIFY AND KNOW TO BE SAFE.**
- [6] Familiarise yourself with the plants that are listed on the endangered species list for your area. Apart from being unethical, it is also illegal to pick endangered plant species.
- [7] Don't be greedy! Only pick as much as you need and never take ALL the plants of any one kind in a given patch. After harvesting an area, give the plants plenty of time to recover before returning to the same patch. If in doubt, don't collect.

Know the Law!

[8] The Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department (AFCD) says it is illegal to cut, pick, or uproot any plant or part of a plant, whether living or dead, from within a country park area without express permission. It's also illegal to dig up plants from private land without permission from the landowner.

Text 3

Foraging in Hong Kong

- [1] Wanda Huang is an experienced Hong Kong forager who knows how to identify edible and medicinal plants. Huang tries to incorporate foraged food and materials into her daily life and avoids processed and synthetic products as much as possible. She even makes her own wine and shampoos.
- [2] Huang's interest in foraging started when she was a child in Canada and her father took her on outings and taught her how to identify herbs and plants in the wild. "We picked blueberries and made pancakes for breakfast, we made tea from pine needles and pine cones, and then we cut the pine cones for the nuts. It was, for me, such a fun experience growing up," she says fondly. "And we don't have to spend time farming — constantly ploughing the land and sowing seeds. Foraging happens naturally, just like when humans were hunters and gatherers," Huang says.
- [3] The vegetables we grow today originated from wild plants which had long roots that penetrated deep into the soil. This means they absorbed a wide range of nutrients and trace minerals from the soil. Huang says that over time, commercial farming has produced bigger, sweeter, and faster-growing vegetables but their roots have shortened. As a result, they no longer absorb all of the trace minerals and nutrients found deep in the soil. "This is why it's healthier to eat wild plants than store-bought vegetables," Huang says.

[4] Huang holds foraging workshops, which are particularly welcomed by chefs from high-end restaurants. "There's real interest from the food and beverage industry in Hong Kong and they're fascinated about what is edible around them," Huang says. Uwe Opocensky, the chef-owner of a restaurant in Sheung Wan, says, "the taste is much deeper because the plants grow in a natural environment and the flavour is really related to the soil."

[5] Hong Kong provides rich pickings for foragers because of its high biodiversity. The territory lies in the subtropical zone, which means it provides ideal conditions for both tropical plants and plants that grow in colder climates. Apart from collecting wild plants for food, people also forage for a wide range of medicinal plants to use in Chinese medicine or dietary therapy. The local herbal tea, 24 flavours, is a good example of how rich Hong Kong is in wild herbs and medicinal plants.

[6] Nevertheless, it is hard for Hong Kong people to incorporate foraging into their lifestyle because they work such long hours and simply do not have the time. "People now go to the supermarket and eat bananas from Chile and pak choi from the Mainland. They've lost their connection with the environment," Huang says. It is mainly elderly villagers who still possess local knowledge about edible wild plants. Huang is sad that most people do not see this knowledge as valuable. "To me, foraging is not about making money but about re-establishing our connection to the environment and our culture," Huang says.

Text 4

Questions from the Internet

[1] Naturalist and avid forager John Wright answers questions from the internet about the fun of finding your own food and the surprising delights growing outside.

[2] @13happy_mushroom asks: **How did you get into foraging?**

[3] It was mushrooms that first got me interested. I encountered a mushroom and was annoyed that I didn't know what it was. So, I took it home, bought a book, and managed to identify the species. I've carried on ever since. I started teaching evening classes and now I lead mushroom picking trips and I'm currently working on my ninth nature guidebook.

[4] @nature_gurl asks: **What's the appeal of finding wild food?**

[5] It's a gentle way for people to go out and engage with the natural world, but there's so much more to it. Foraging has a massive sense of freedom and release from modern day life. A connection to nature is something very special that, in my eyes, is a privilege and I'm lucky enough to have found a way to make a living from it.

[6] @eat_to_live1234 asks: **What are the benefits of foraging?**

[7] Foraging naturally slows you down to become more observant and you gain an appreciation for the little things which, for me, are the most important. The physical activity involved in searching for wild edibles in nature provides a low-impact way to move your body while enjoying the great outdoors. Foraging also has some mental health benefits. Spending time in green spaces can help reduce stress, help people cope with anxiety, and provide relief from depression, as well as improve overall mood and well-being.

[8] @EarthFirst2024 asks: **There seems to be a trend in people choosing to forage. Why do you think this is?**

[9] I think food in general has become something people pay more attention to. A new respect for ourselves with regard to how we treat our bodies, has pushed people towards smaller producers of better quality food. Small cottage industries and producers are now more popular with organic and natural processes being favoured, and there's nothing more organic than foraged wild food!

END OF READING PASSAGES

Sources of materials used in this paper will be acknowledged in the HKDSE Question Papers booklet published by the Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority at a later stage.

HKDSE 2025
ENGLISH LANGUAGE
PAPER 1 PART B2
QUESTION-ANSWER BOOK



Write your Candidate Number and stick a barcode label in the space provided on this page.
Read Text 5 and answer questions 43-64. (42 marks)

Text 5

43. What does the writer mean when he describes quiet quitting as 'buzzy' (line 1)?

Quiet quitting...

- A. attracts criticism.
B. is full of lively activity.
C. receives a lot of attention.
D. generates intense excitement.

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

44. Find TWO examples of quiet quitting 'doing the rounds today' (line 1). (2 marks)

- (i) _____
(ii) _____

45. Explain why the term quiet quitting 'is misleading' (line 6). (2 marks)

- (i) 'quiet': _____
(ii) 'quitting': _____

46. Find TWO examples from paragraph 2 of focusing on 'what a job is and isn't' (line 10). (2 marks)

- (i) _____
(ii) _____

47. Which of the following is NOT mentioned in paragraph 3 as a cause of quiet quitting?

- A. Discontent in the workforce
B. Staff considering resignation
C. Old-fashioned workplace standards
D. Staff experiencing increasing workloads

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

48. What is the purpose of paragraph 3?

- A. Defining what quiet quitting is
B. Indicating that quiet quitting is a modern issue
C. Suggesting alternative reasons for quiet quitting
D. Debating the possible explanations of quiet quitting

A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Answers written in the margin will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.



re.

49. Which word or phrase in paragraph 4 means to 'finish your work activity'?

50. Bulger says "work-life enrichment prioritizes self-care in one area and tends to breed success in the other" (lines 17-18). What does 'one area' and 'the other' refer to? (2 marks)

(i) 'one area': _____

(ii) 'the other': _____

51. What does 'it' (line 21) refer to?

52. According to paragraph 5, decide whether the following statements are True (T), False (F) or Not Given (NG). (4 marks)

Statements	T	F	NG
(i) No one today believes Gen Z are hardworking.	☐	☐	☐
(ii) Online groups helping people to review different aspects of their lives bloomed during the pandemic.	☐	☐	☐
(iii) The Nap Ministry's growth in its number of followers is unique.	☐	☐	☐
(iv) Tens of thousands of people complain about their jobs every day.	☐	☐	☐

53. What does 'only one note in this growing chorus' (line 27) suggest about the quiet quitting trend?

54. Who does 'we' (line 29) refer to?

55. Use a word or phrase in each blank to complete the following statement based on the information in paragraph 7. (2 marks)

Employers have responded to workers' apparent 'slacking' by (i) _____

the duties and opportunities of relevant staff, resulting in dire consequences. This has been labelled

(ii) _____.

56. Borchers says 'reputations suffer as a result of perceived apathy' (lines 33-34). Whose reputations does he refer to?

Answers written in the margin will not be marked.

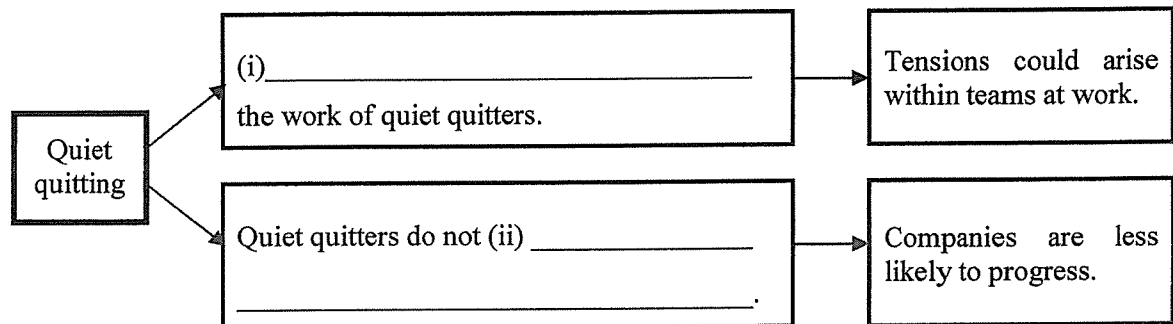
57. In paragraph 7, what words or phrases mean 'ending someone's employment'? (2 marks)

(i) _____

(ii) _____

58. What 'decision' (line 37) does Vari discuss in paragraph 8?

59. With reference to paragraph 8, complete the following diagram describing the possible consequences of quiet quitting. (2 marks)



60. Based on the information in paragraph 9, complete the summary of the paragraph by writing ONE word in each blank below. Your answers must be grammatically correct. (5 marks)

The youth of today are digital natives, which proved to be (i) _____ to them in their studies during the pandemic. However, after starting (ii) _____, this has resulted in some resentment from (iii) _____ workers moaning about quiet quitters being on social media. The fact is, many prefer studying and working (iv) _____ rather than in 'real life.' Aptly, quiet quitting (v) _____ with an influencer's online quote: "Your worth as a person is not defined by your labor."

61. Who or what are the 'forebears' (line 50) mentioned in paragraph 10?

62. Newport discusses quiet quitting in relation to Gen Z. With reference to paragraph 10, explain why Gen Z's use of technology can be both positive and negative. (2 marks)

(i) Positive: _____

(ii) Negative: _____

Answers written in the margin will not be marked.

63. Use the information in Text 5 to match each of the following comments with a person (A-G) mentioned in the text. Write the letter of the person on the line next to the comment. Each letter can be used ONCE only. The first has been done as an example. (6 marks)

A. Carrie Bulger	B. Tricia Hersey	C. Callum Borchers	D. Gergo Vari	E. Zaid Khan	F. Cal Newport	G. Barnaby Lashbrooke
Comment						Person
This is how I can connect with people with similar beliefs.						<u>B (example)</u>
The repercussions impact those around you.						(i) _____
Different people do this for different reasons.						(ii) _____
Let's be honest, work has its place in life.						(iii) _____
Of all of us, I think Gen Z can lead the way.						(iv) _____
Consider how this could have a downside for you.						(v) _____
We need to look beyond the daily for life's true value.						(vi) _____

Read the Comments section (lines 61-71) and answer question 64.

64. Which of the following would be cynical towards the idea 'Quiet quitting is right for today'?

- A. Nikia203
B. Lewis43
C. Jessef04
D. Luna903

- A B C D
☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

END OF PART B2

Answers written in the margin will not be marked.

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 1

PART B2

Reading Passages

8:30 am – 10:00 am (1 hour 30 minutes)
(for both Parts A and B)

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

- (1) Refer to the General Instructions on Page 1 of the Reading Passages booklet for Part A.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR PART B2

- (1) The Question-Answer Book for Part B2 is inserted in this Reading Passages booklet.
- (2) Candidates who choose Part B2 should attempt all questions in this part. Each question carries ONE mark unless otherwise stated.
- (3) Hand in only ONE Question-Answer Book for Part B, either B1 or B2, and fasten it with the Question-Answer Book for Part A using the green tag provided.

Not to be taken away before the
end of the examination session

PART B2

Read Text 5 and answer questions 43-64 in the Question-Answer Book for Part B2.

Text 5

Quiet Quitting

[1] Quiet quitting is a buzzy term doing the rounds today. In fact, a Google search produces hits from The Washington Post, The New York Times, The Wall Street Journal, and countless academic publications. At this moment, at least 50% of the North American workforce is engaged in a wave of disengagement dubbed quiet quitting. But what does it mean and how will it impact university graduates as they prepare to embark on 21st-century careers?

What is quiet quitting?

[2] As many have noted the term itself is misleading. No, it does not refer to wordlessly slipping out the door or logging out of the group chat without so much as a peace sign emoji. Nor does it mean an employee permanently abandoning their post. Quiet quitters believe a more accurate way to describe this is working your contract or acting your wage. Carrie Bulger, PhD, a professor of organizational psychology, defines quiet quitting as “a renewed effort to really focus on what a job is and isn’t.”

[3] No matter what terminology we use, quiet quitting is less a harbinger of widespread revolt and more of a long overdue reckoning with outdated practices and stale office culture. “For some people, it’s probably a sign of dissatisfaction and a sign that they’re going to leave,” Bulger said. “But I think for others, it’s something else.”

[4] Being forced to work at home amid the tumult of 2020 was an eye-opening experience, one that emboldened even the most dedicated employees to set healthy boundaries. And enforcing those boundaries can appear, through the lens of leadership, like slacking. “But it is quite possible to be invested in your work and redirect that passion once you clock out for the day. Pursuing work-life enrichment prioritizes self-care in one area and tends to breed success in the other,” Bulger said.

Going against the grind

[5] The signs are all around us — productivity is no longer seen as the badge of honor it once was, and Generation Z are starting to question how relevant it is while seeking better frameworks that support the kind of life they want to live. Launched in 2013, one online community that exists for people who ‘want help with their own work-life related struggles’ saw an upsurge in followers in late 2021. The Instagram account The Nap Ministry has a similar popularity arc and saw a huge explosion of followers since the start of the pandemic, numbering in the tens of thousands per day. Tricia Hersey, its creator, believes Gen Z work hard; they just don’t want to live to work. To her, and to many others, it is about “not running ourselves into the ground.”

[6] Quiet quitting is only one note in this growing chorus, and we should be careful not to dismiss it as just another trend or a singular occurrence. Instead, we should step back and look at the whole picture and what that means for the way we’ve been working and how we should move forward.

[7] There are, of course, divergent perspectives on quiet quitting. There’s what it means for workers and what it means for panicked employers in a precarious economy, and the collision of those viewpoints can have drastic consequences for the former. Writing for The Wall Street Journal, columnist Callum Borchers outlined the perils of quiet quitting. Borchers has encountered a new term quiet firing in which reputations suffer as a result of perceived apathy; responsibilities are gradually diminished and a path toward actual termination materializes. “Companies have always had subtle ways to nudge people out the door,” Borchers said. “Tactics include sidelining them by cutting responsibilities or denying promotions and raises to make someone miserable enough to leave.”

[8] Gergo Vari, CEO of online job searching platform Lensa, also believes the decision won’t serve employees long-term either. “Anytime that you silence your own voice in an organization, you may be depriving yourself of the opportunity to change that organization.” Stepping away from hustle culture can also cause tension between employees and may result in a rift between fellow colleagues who may have to pick up the slack. “If people feel like their co-workers aren’t committed to quality work there can be friction inside teams and organizations.”

A generational divide

[9] Today’s college students are rightly praised for their resiliency. But the same skills that made them so adaptable during the pandemic — they are digital natives who prefer Zoom lectures to the real thing — make them the target of generational disdain once they enter the workforce. Can’t you just hear the grumbling: We wouldn’t have to worry about quiet quitting if these kids would get off TikTok and do their jobs. Fittingly, the movement’s origins can be

traced to TikTok, the massively popular video-sharing app, where the influencer Zaid Khan uttered a phrase that's been quoted in countless news articles: "Your worth as a person is not defined by your labor."

[10] In an essay for The New Yorker, Cal Newport, an associate professor of computer science, posits that Gen Z is better equipped than its forebears to leverage technology to push back against workplace norms. Gen Z enters the workforce with "a mindset that is notably distinct from the millennials who preceded them," Newport writes. As the first group to fully come of age with smartphones and social media, Gen Z "formed an understanding of the world in which the boundaries between the digital and real are blurred." They have so thoroughly mixed work and self, the suffocating grimness of modern office life hits a more personal level and it has become clear to many that they need to separate their personhood from their jobs.

[11] Work, of course, remains essential within our current economic and social environment and trends like quiet quitting are inevitable during times of great upheaval. What we need to do is take a step back and take a critical look at how we can adapt the way we work to suit our current context while promoting a more modern and balanced way of life. As Barnaby Lashbrooke wrote in Forbes: "Of course we have to work: to put a roof overhead and food on the table. But life should come first, and work should be the enabler."

Comments:

Nikia203 1 April 2025 10:45

Figuring out how work fits into a life well lived is hard, but I think it's an evolution that has to happen. The question is what comes next.

Lewis43 1 April 2025 12:23

I'm not going to put in a sixty-hour workweek and pull myself up by my bootstraps for a job that doesn't care about me as a person.

Jessef04 1 April 2025 14:47

If you're doing this, you're a loser. This is like a virus. This is worse than COVID.

Luna903 2 April 2025 08:56

I'd rather my kid was a quiet quitter than being unemployed just lounging about at home playing online games.

END OF READING PASSAGE

Sources of materials used in this paper will be acknowledged in the *HKDSE Question Papers* booklet published by the Hong Kong Examinations and Assessment Authority at a later stage.